

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

These knowledge check questions are designed to be used at the end of each SAFe course lesson to check for learning and comprehension. They are optional and can be shared with the class in a variety of formats including live class discussion, small group, discussion, or for individual student reflection. The questions can also be copied/pasted into a polling tool for real-time class feedback and discussion.

Lesson 1:

1. What are the three essential collaborations necessary for Lean portfolio management implementation? (Choose three.)

- A. Program increment planning
- B. Lean governance
- C. Agile portfolio operations
- D. Participatory budgeting
- E. Strategy and investment funding
- F. Agile program management office

Correct Answer: B,C,E

2. Which objective is achieved by organizing a portfolio around value?

- A. Faster learning and shorter time to market
- B. True cost accounting metrics
- C. Increased task completion
- D. Communication across the organization

Correct Answer: A

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. How does Lean portfolio management mitigate and manage risk?

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

Lesson 2:

1. Which two key functions do strategic themes perform? (Choose two.)

- A. Generating lean business cases for portfolio epics
- B. Reflecting dependencies in the value stream network
- C. Connecting the portfolio to the enterprise strategy
- D. Determining key metrics to measure progress
- E. Setting context for portfolio vision and lean budgeting

Correct Answer: C,E

2. What is one way of expressing future intent in a Lean portfolio?

- A) Strategic themes
- B) Investment areas
- C) Three-year delivery plans
- D) Feature roadmaps

Correct: A

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. What is a benefit of using strategic themes?

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

Lesson 3:

1. When creating an epic hypothesis, the value statement is supported by what quantifiable outputs and technical considerations?

- A. Leading indicators, budget, and technical requirements
- B. Key partners, business outcome hypothesis, and design specifications
- C. Leading indicators, business outcome hypothesis, and non-functional requirements
- D. Key partners, budget, and minimum viable product functionality

Correct Answer: C

2. Maria needs some technical guidance in order to complete the Lean business case. Who should she ask for help?

- A. The enterprise architect
- B. The solution manager
- C. The system team
- D. The business owner

Correct Answer: A

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. Which role is typically the epic owner for an enabler epic?

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

Lesson 4:

1. How do you ensure that near-term opportunities are not missed while allocating money for the future?

- A. Maintain a balance across investment horizons
- B. Sequence strategic themes with objectives and key results
- C. Use weighted shortest job first to sequence opportunities
- D. Engage business owners and stakeholders in participatory budgeting

Correct Answer: A

2. How does Lean budgeting differ from traditional budgeting?

- A. It leverages rolling-wave planning to allocate funds
- B. Project governance is leaner and more adaptable
- C. Annual planning is performed more efficiently
- D. More deterministic planning drives better outcomes

Correct Answer: A

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. What are two ways Lean budgets help produce better outcomes?

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

Lesson 5:

1. Who can approve an epic in the portfolio kanban, if it exceeds the portfolio threshold?

- A. Lean portfolio management
- B. Enterprise architects
- C. Agile program management office
- D. Epic owners

Correct Answer: A

2. How does the SAFe principle #1, take an economic view, apply to the portfolio?

- A. By considering money already spent
- B. By making funding decisions annually
- C. By sequencing epics for maximum benefit
- D. By centralizing strategic decisions at this level

Correct Answer: C

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. What is the goal of the weighted shortest job first prioritization model in Lean portfolio management?

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

Lesson 6:

1. What would be appropriate areas of focus for a Lean-Agile Center of Excellence? (choose three)

- A. Create alignment around organizational change
- B. Manage decentralized decision-making
- C. Determine epic allocation to Agile release trains
- D. Promote better coding practices
- E. Establish objective metrics
- F. Provide coaching and training to Agile release trains

Correct Answer: A,E,F

2. What are three activities supported by a Lean-Agile Center of Excellence? (Choose three.)

- A. Identifying value streams
- B. Establishing objective metrics
- C. Coaching and training
- D. Identifying communities of practice
- E. Defining organizational structure
- F. Assigning people to key SAFe roles

Correct Answer: A,B,C

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. What is one advantage of having an Agile program management office?

Lean Portfolio Management® 5 - Knowledge Check Questions

Lesson 7:

1. When establishing metrics, what might an organization focus on from a portfolio perspective that closely aligns with SAFe principles?

- A. CapEx vs OpEx spending
- B. Flow and cycle time
- C. Cost of delay
- D. Market rhythms

Correct Answer: B

2. What is a key characteristic of a Lean quality management system?

- A. Building the solution and compliance incrementally
- B. Investing in devops and automation testing
- C. Reducing the holding costs associated with compliance
- D. Deferring compliance to the end of solution development

Correct Answer: A

Open-ended Discussion Question:

3. What is one thing an organization can do to move from traditional quality management systems to Lean quality management systems?

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